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COSMIC DASH

A SPACE-JUNK CLEANUP GAME

THE KESSLER SYNDROME

How it works

1. Two satellites collide
2. The collision creates thousands of fragments
3. Those fragments collide with other satellites
4. Each collision creates even more debris
5. This repeats, causing a cascade effect

Eventually, certain orbital regions could become so dangerous that satellites cannot safely operate there.



Environment Statistics

Last update: 16 January 2026

Space debris by the numbers

Number of rocket launches since the start of the space age in 1957

About 7170 (excluding failures)

Number of satellites these rocket launches have placed into Earth orbit

About 25170

Number of these still in space

About 16910

Number of these still functioning

About 14200

Number of space objects regularly tracked by Space Surveillance Networks and maintained in their catalogue

About 44870

Estimated number of break-ups, explosions, collisions, or anomalous events resulting in fragmentation

More than 650

Total mass of all space objects in Earth orbit

More than 15800 tonnes

Not all objects are tracked and catalogued. The number of objects estimated based on statistical models to be in orbit

([MASTER-8](#), reference population 08/2024)

54000 space objects greater than 10 cm (including approx. 9300 active payloads)

1.2 million space debris objects from greater than 1 cm to 10 cm

140 million space debris objects from greater than 1 mm to 1 cm

